

MAKE YOUR RICH LIFE RICHER

CONCLUSION

When I went on book tour, there was a woman in Pasadena, California, who raised her hand to volunteer for my Money Dials exercise. Let's call her Nicole. I asked her what she loved spending money on.

"Clothes! I love Topshop," Nicole blurted out. You could hear in her voice the excitement of finally being able to share that passion—combined with embarrassment over the seeming frivolity of it. The entire room instantly loved her.

I asked what she would do if she could quadruple her spending on clothes. Nicole grinned. "I would have boxes of clothes *everywhere*." The audience lit up with laughter.

"Okay, imagine you're doubling, quadrupling, even 10x-ing your spending on clothes. Where would you shop?"

She got very quiet, then said, "I don't know. Topshop, I guess?"

This was the moment I was hoping for. When we think about our Rich Life, we often get stuck imagining how to make it bigger. She reacted like so many others for whom I've asked this question: "If I like clothes and I can quadruple my spending, I'll just buy four times as many clothes!"

But there's another way. I gently pointed out that if she spent extravagantly on the things she truly loved, she might not shop at Topshop anymore at all. I suggested she might instead purchase clothes from a higher-end store, or even one day fly to Italy to get a beautiful custom coat designed. And she could take her mom along to buy matching coats together.

We usually think "richer" is synonymous with "bigger," and we think of bigger as "more," like shopping at Costco. But as you get older, you realize that bigger can mean very different things. Look back over your answers in this section and you might discover that "bigger" might mean taking risks to create new and life-changing experiences, or balancing the time you spend doing work vs. leisure.

Nicole realized she'd been thinking about her Rich Life in a linear way: More spending equals more boxes of clothes. But she could redefine